

TEAM CATALYST ALLIANCE – Kickoff Meeting 01

UN SDG Goal 2: Zero Hunger – Surplus Food Redistribution Network

Date: Saturday, 18 July 2026

Time: 6:00 PM WAT | 7:00 PM SAST | 8:00 PM EAT

Platform: meet.google.com/ggf-shah-uud

Duration: 45–60 minutes

Attendees

- Oke Oluwatoyin – Project Management
- Zoliswa Mokopu – Cybersecurity
- Omoruyi Igbinovia – Data Analytics
- Lydia Nganga – IT Automation with Python
- Esther Vincent – Digital Marketing

Purpose and Expectations

This kickoff meeting is intended to establish a shared understanding of our project, align on expectations, discuss our approach, and agree on the next steps. By the end of the meeting, the team should have a clear understanding of the project objectives, initial responsibilities, and immediate action items.

Agenda

Topic 1: Welcome & Team Introductions

- Introductions
- Country / Time zone
- Grow with Google track
- Relevant experience (optional)

Topic 2: Project Overview

- Review the project brief
- Review the problem statement
- Review the project timeline
- Review submission requirements
- Review grading rubric
- Define what success looks like for our team

Topic 3: Project Discovery

- Discuss our understanding of the problem
- Identify stakeholders

- Identify assumptions and knowledge gaps
- Discuss realistic solution directions
- Discuss what a successful MVP could look like
- Identify research questions

Topic 4: Team Planning

- Discuss how each discipline can contribute
- Agree on communication expectations
- Decide on a documentation approach
- Confirm GitHub and Google Drive structure
- Discuss meeting cadence

Topic 5: Action Items & Next Steps

- Assign research responsibilities
- Assign documentation responsibilities
- Confirm deliverables before the next meeting
- Schedule the next meeting
- Open discussions & next steps

Meeting Notes

Discussion Summary

1. Project Scope and Core Objective

The team aligned on addressing UN SDG Goal 2, Zero Hunger, by promoting the redistribution of surplus food to reduce waste and hunger (07:00).

- Oluwatoyin explained that the project aims to connect vendors with surplus food to NGOs and end users in need, tackling expired food waste and food scarcity.
- The solution involves connecting urban vendors with rural populations through intermediaries such as NGOs, highlighting the need for a practical system for food coordination.
- The group agreed they will likely develop a minimum viable product or prototype to demonstrate the feasibility of the redistribution idea.
- The automated coordination of hyperlocal food distribution was identified as a key technical challenge central to the project's value.

2. Team Roles, Responsibilities, and Skills

The team clarified individual roles and identified skill gaps, especially around GitHub usage and technical contributions (11:33).

- Omoruyi is responsible for data analytics and gathering relevant data to define the problem and validate the solution.
- Oluwatoyin will manage project documentation, including the project charter and risk plans, and oversee timelines to ensure deadlines are met.

- Zoliswa brings cybersecurity expertise and is expected to support solution development and security considerations.
- The group acknowledged a lack of current GitHub proficiency, agreeing that at least one member must quickly learn GitHub for submission purposes.
- Automation and digital marketing roles will be assigned based on members' expertise, with Lydia expected to contribute to automation given her background.

3. Research and Data Gathering Strategy

The team agreed to deepen research efforts individually and collaboratively to build a solid foundation for the project (19:04).

- Each member will conduct focused research on UN SDG goals, the problem context, and potential solutions before the next meeting.
- Omoruyi will leverage this collective research to source and analyze data relevant to the food redistribution challenge.
- Zoliswa emphasized exploring the broader set of the UN's 17 Sustainable Development Goals to identify complementary ideas for the project's scope.
- The next meeting was set for early next week to share findings, refine the problem statement, and outline concrete deliverables.

4. Project Management and Timeline

The team set a clear timeline to complete the project by the August 14th deadline, targeting about three weeks for all deliverables (08:53).

- Oluwatoyin will draft meeting notes and action items after each meeting to maintain alignment and track progress.
- The group committed to meeting every two to three days during the research and development phase to stay on schedule.
- They recognized the need to balance workload across research, technical development, and documentation to optimize efficiency.
- The aim is to deliver a quality solution that can compete for a top-three spot, motivating the team to bring their best efforts.

5. Evaluation Criteria and Quality Focus

The team reviewed the grading rubric to prioritize efforts according to weighted components in the assessment (24:49).

- Zoliswa highlighted that the code base and solution quality together account for 50% of the total marks, emphasizing the importance of technical excellence.
- Oluwatoyin stressed the critical role of the technical team in delivering a robust, functional prototype aligned with project goals.
- Documentation, project management, and research are also essential but secondary to the technical solution in scoring.

- This insight shaped the team's strategy to focus heavily on automation and cybersecurity features while maintaining clear, concise documentation.

6. Communication and Coordination Challenges

Initial communication issues were noted, with some members missing key emails and updates (22:40).

- Zoliswa did not receive early project communications, which delayed her full engagement until the meeting.
- The team agreed to share all critical links and documents promptly in the group chat to keep everyone informed.
- They emphasized the importance of clear, frequent communication to ensure all members remain aligned and productive.
- Oluwatoyin took responsibility for maintaining this communication flow and ensuring everyone has access to the necessary materials.

Key Decisions

Decision	Reason
Focus the project on developing a practical solution for surplus food redistribution aligned with UN SDG Goal 2.	Aligns with the assigned problem statement and project objective.
Develop a minimum viable product (MVP) or prototype.	Demonstrates the feasibility of the proposed solution within the project timeline.
Meet every 2–3 days during the research and development phase.	Maintain momentum and ensure timely completion before the deadline.
Conduct individual research before the next meeting.	Build a strong understanding of the problem and support solution development with evidence.
Share all project resources through the team communication channels.	Improve collaboration and keep all team members informed.

Action Items

Task	Owner	Due date	Status
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Research the problem, UN SDG Goal 2, and potential solutions.	All Team Members	Before the next meeting	Not Started
Gather and analyze relevant datasets.	Omoruyi	Before the next meeting	Not Started
Prepare the Project Charter and project management documents.	Oluwatoyin	Before the next meeting	In Progress
Explore GitHub workflows and repository management.	All Team Members	Before submission	Not Started
Share meeting notes and project resources with the team.	Oluwatoyin	After the meeting	Completed

Parking Lot (Items for Future Discussion)

- Final solution selection after research.
- GitHub repository structure and workflow.
- MVP feature prioritization.
- Technical architecture and implementation approach.
- Presentation and walkthrough video planning.

Next Meeting

Date: 23rd of July, 2026

Time: 8:00 PM WAT / 9:00 PM SAST / 10:00 PM EAT

Agenda:

- Share individual research findings.
- Refine the problem statement.
- Review datasets and supporting evidence.
- Agree on the proposed solution.
- Assign technical and documentation deliverables.